FREE CHECKLIST

Paid Family Leave Checklist for New Parents in New York

Check each item before you submit your bonding leave application.

1. Know your eligibility and dates

- [ ] I worked for my employer 26 consecutive weeks (20+ hours a week) or 175 days (under 20 hours a week).
- [ ] My leave starts after the child is born, adopted or placed. Bonding leave can't start before the birth.
- [ ] I plan to take bonding leave within 12 months of the birth, adoption or placement.
- [ ] If I'm giving birth, I planned the order: disability (DBL) for recovery first, then PFL for bonding. They can't be collected at the same time.
- [ ] DBL and PFL together max out at 26 weeks in a 52-week period.
- [ ] I told my employer at least 30 days ahead if I could, or as soon as possible.

2. Gather your documents

- [ ] Request for Paid Family Leave (form PFL-1), with my part completed.
- [ ] Bonding Certification (form PFL-2).
- [ ] Proof of the birth, adoption or placement, as listed in the PFL-2 packet (for a birth: a provider's certification or a birth certificate).
- [ ] If I'm the other parent: proof of my relationship (birth certificate, acknowledgment of parentage, court order, or marriage or partnership proof).
- [ ] My employer's name and my start date.
- [ ] Any letters from the insurance carrier.

3. Employer and carrier steps

- [ ] I gave PFL-1 to my employer to complete their section. They have 3 business days to return it.
- [ ] Every section is complete and signed before I send anything.
- [ ] I sent the full package to the carrier within 30 days after my leave starts.
- [ ] I kept a copy of everything, plus the date I sent it.
- [ ] The carrier generally must pay or deny within 18 days of a complete request.

4. Avoid common delays

- [ ] No missing proof.
- [ ] The right form, not just a doctor's note.
- [ ] No blank or incomplete employer sections.
- [ ] My name, dates and signatures match on every page.

My key dates

Birth, adoption or placement date: _____

My leave starts: _____

PFL-1 given to employer: _____

Sent to the carrier by (30 days after leave starts): _____

Want a second set of eyes before you submit?
Free eligibility check and consultation. Email info@nysdbladvisors.com

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Official forms are free at paidfamilyleave.ny.gov. Rules, amounts and forms change, so confirm details with the official site. Please don't email Social Security numbers or medical records. NYS DBL & PFL Advisors is an independent advisory service, not a law firm, insurance carrier or broker, and is not affiliated with the State of New York or the Workers' Compensation Board. This checklist is general information, not legal advice. Last reviewed November 12, 2026.